

KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA Delhi GRAND CENTRAL

Rishi Agarwal left his family in Bihar and moved to Delhi when he was 16, the draw being a better education. "The Kendriya Vidyalaya (kv) in my village was only till Class X and had no commerce stream. I joined kv, R.K. Puram, because it was known for its overall performance," says the commerce topper, who scored an aggregate of 90.4 per cent in his Class XII CBSE examination. Counted among the best schools in Delhi, kv, R.K. Puram, holds the record for consistently producing toppers and having the best infrastructure amongst the 980 kvs in the country. And what sets it apart is "the interdependence between a confident and competent faculty and a disciplined and committed body of students," says S.P. Thakur, 55, principal of R.K. Puram since 2006. He initiated projects for the development of communicative competence in English, handwriting and IT into classroom teaching. "According to an internal

THAKUR, THE PROUD PRINCIPAL, SHOWS OFF HIS CLASS X AND XII BOARD TOPPERS

survey, students who joined the school with as low as 57 per cent marks, graduated with an approximate of 78 per cent," says Pragya Srivastava, joint commissioner (administration). Whether it's multi-media tools, IT, sports facilities or academics, the kvs are slowly breaking

away from the traditional perception of government schools and the result can be seen in their results—an aggregate percentage of 91 per cent in Class XII CBSE examination as opposed to a mere 81.68 per cent for private schools in 2007-08.

by Purvi Malhotra

193 KVs out of 980 had a **100 per cent** result in the Class X CBSE exam in 2008.



PREM JYOTI PRANGAN Jamshedpur IGNITING MINDS



MUKHERJEE'S EFFORTS HAVE HELPED THE SCHOOL CARVE A NICHE FOR ITSELF

Prem Jyoti Prangan has educated around **600 children** in Jamshedpur.

Suvra Mukherjee, 61, is a woman on a mission. In 1977, she joined her mentor Maya Ghosh, wife of a senior Tata Steel officer, to set up a school for underprivileged children coming from homes of domestic help, rickshaw-pullers and labourers. Prem Jyoti Prangan, which started in Ghosh's home with only three students, now has around 600 students, all paying a nominal fee of Rs 25 per month. After Ghosh's husband, a TISCO officer, retired, the house had to be vacated. The then TISCO managing director J.J. Irani offered two rooms where the school was resumed. In 1999, Ghosh was stricken with cancer and after her death Mukherjee proceeded to head the school. Today, it is a full-fledged school, up to Class X. Every year a batch successfully completes the Jharkhand Matriculation Examination, with the help of 20 teachers who are given an honorarium. Among the success stories, Mukherjee says, "Watch out for Swapna Patnaik from East Singhbhum. She got 83 per cent marks in her Board and wants to become an engineer. Her mother works as a domestic help". If this is not success and the real spirit of India, what else is, she asks.

by Abhijit Dasgupta